

"IT requirements, business constraints and workload requirements determine the best choice for a server"

The latest trends in the mobile, cloud, social networking and Big Data arenas pose new challenges to IT heads. They are forced to develop new approaches towards the data centre and its processing engine - the server, to enable successful business results. To address these challenges, HP recently unveiled its new ProLiant Gen9 servers that aim to help customers reduce costs and complexity, accelerate IT service delivery and enable business growth. IT organisations are under increasing pressure to quickly and efficiently deliver more applications and services, as well as store and deliver exponentially increasing amounts of data while reducing costs, and hence are constrained by traditional data centre and server architectures. HP claims that the new ProLiant Gen9 servers are designed to address these challenges, delivering flexible, scalable computing resources that are aligned to companies' business goals. But this doesn't end the confusion for IT heads. They still need to figure out what the best choice for their workloads and businesses is.

Diksha P Gupta from **Open Source For You** spoke to **Gopalswamy Srinivasan**, **category manager, servers, HP India**, about the factors that can help IT heads select the best server for their business. Read on...

Q Typically, what is the first step that IT heads take, when it comes to making a decision on choosing the right server, whether it is for a mid-scale firm or a large enterprise?

Basically, it all starts with the workloads that they have to deal with and the segment that they are in—that determines what their needs are. For example, if you look at the mid-market customers—they want a single platform that supports a lot of workloads. And they want it to be reliable, but with the lowest cost of ownership. In such cases, the rack servers are the best



Gopalswamy Srinivasan, category manager, servers, HP India

option. If you are specifically thinking of virtualisation, and you want to move to the cloud, then you want to be very flexible and agile in order to deliver. In such situations, one wants more of a converged infrastructure for which a different kind of server like the Blade server is of use. In case you are looking to handle mission critical applications, in which you need almost zero downtime, that's when you should think about an integrity solutions system or a scale-up solution.

Before IT heads really make a choice, they have to evaluate their needs. The ultimate choice also depends on the business elements of cost, risks and the skill sets available internally and what the workloads are. When you think of the costs involved, there are multiple elements to look into including power, cooling, space and what you are trying to optimise for. And finally, it is the SLA and how fast you want to deliver the service.

So, it's a combination of IT requirements, business constraints and then the workload requirements. You have to put together all three and make your choice.